

- **Instructions to ChatGPT Project for the rest of the internship -**

You are my web development tutor and mentor throughout this portfolio project.

About me:

I am a second-year undergraduate student at IIT Bombay studying Environmental Science and Engineering. I am learning HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, Git, and Firebase. I am building my first professional portfolio website to improve my web development skills and showcase my projects.

My proof statement:

I design clean, responsive, and modern + animated websites for student organizations and university departments that want a professional online presence. Through my portfolio, I aim to demonstrate my skills and encourage student leaders, clubs, and organizations to contact me for website design and development opportunities.

Your role:

Act as a tutor, not just an assistant. Explain your reasoning before giving solutions. Help me understand concepts instead of simply completing my work. Review my ideas, sitemap, designs, and code, pointing out strengths, weaknesses, and improvements. Recommend modern UI/UX practices, accessibility, responsive design, semantic HTML, clean CSS, and JavaScript best practices. If there are multiple good approaches, compare them and explain the trade-offs. Assume I am still learning and teach me step by step.

- **Prompt to ChatGPT for reviewing my portfolio and point out what is different from the sitemap-**

“This is my proof statement: {I design modern, responsive websites for university department associations that want to attract more students, members, and sponsors. I transform outdated websites into polished, engaging experiences that reflect the energy of the community behind them. As a student, I understand what makes a department website feel welcoming, credible, and worth exploring. If you're responsible for your department association's website and want it to make a stronger first impression, email me.}. This is my sitemap: {SITE MAP}. Does this sitemap walk my one person from landing, to believing me, to taking my one action, and does it actually prove my claim? Tell me which pages earn their place, which are wasted, and what is missing. Be specific, not encouraging. ”

- **Response-**

What I personally learnt-

The skills section is of no use, they don't give a damn about my skills. They just need to know if I am the right candidate to take their websites to the next level. Also, they don't care about my education and “aspiring” web dev. They need to know I am confident enough that I can build their website.

Response-

I like that you're thinking in terms of a sitemap instead of just pages. But if I evaluate it against **your proof statement**, it doesn't work yet.

Your proof statement is:

I design websites for university department associations that want to attract more students, members, and sponsors.

So every page has one job:

Convince someone responsible for a department association website to email you.

Your current sitemap doesn't do that.

Does it walk me from landing → believing → emailing?

Current flow:

Home
↓
Skills
↓
Projects
↓
About
↓
Contact

This is the classic **developer portfolio** flow.

Your proof statement requires this instead:

Home
↓
Proof (Projects / Case Studies)
↓
Why trust me?
↓
Contact

Notice that **Skills** are not part of the persuasion journey.

Nobody hires someone because they listed React before JavaScript.

They hire them because they believe:

"This person can redesign our website."

Page-by-page critique

HOME — Earns its place (but needs a complete rewrite)

Current hero:

"Hi, I'm Vatsal... aspiring web developer..."

This immediately weakens your positioning.

If I'm a department association secretary, I don't care that you're aspiring.

I care whether you can solve **my** problem.

Instead, your hero should answer:

- Who do you help?
- What problem do you solve?
- Why should I stay?

Something like:

I redesign outdated department association websites into modern websites students actually want to explore.

Now I'm interested.

SKILLS — Mostly wasted

This is probably the weakest page.

Current:

- HTML
- CSS
- JS
- React
- Tailwind
- Python

- Git
- C++

Imagine I'm hiring.

Why should I care that you know C++?

I won't.

Even React isn't persuasive.

Skills don't prove competence.

Projects do.

I'd reduce this to a section, not a page.

Example:

Built with HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, GSAP, Three.js.

Done.

PROJECTS — Earns its place, but not in its current form

Right now you have:

- Weather App
- Currency Converter
- Messenger App
- Snake Game

Here's the uncomfortable truth.

None of these prove your claim.

Your claim is:

"I redesign department association websites."

Your projects prove:

"I followed frontend tutorials."

That's a mismatch.

Instead of asking:

"What projects do I have?"

Ask:

"What evidence proves I can build the websites I'm selling?"

Even if you keep these projects, each case study needs to emphasize transferable skills:

- responsive layout
- accessibility
- animations
- information hierarchy
- component design
- performance

Eventually, I would replace them with projects like:

- Department Association Website
- University Lab Website
- Student Club Landing Page

Those align directly with your positioning.

ABOUT — Earns its place, but needs a different purpose

Current:

IIT Bombay

Minor in CSE

Learning Three.js and GSAP

This tells me about you.

It doesn't tell me why I should hire you.

Instead:

I'm a student myself, so I know how students actually use department websites.

That's relevant.

The About page should answer:

"Why are you the right person to redesign **our** website?"

Not:

"Here's my education."

CONTACT — Earns its place

Current:

- LinkedIn
- Instagram

Your proof statement says:

Email me.

Yet your contact page doesn't emphasize email.

That should be your primary CTA.

Example:

Let's redesign your department website.

Email: ...

or

Fill out this short form.

Everything else is secondary.

What's missing?

This is where your portfolio currently falls short.

1. Case Studies (highest priority)

Right now:

Weather App

Better:

Department Website Redesign

Problem

Goals

Design decisions

Responsive layouts

Animations

Final result

That's how agencies present work.

2. Design Process

Show that you think before you code.

Example:

Discover

↓

Research users

↓

Wireframe

↓

Design

↓

Develop

↓

Deploy

A department association hiring you wants confidence that you have a process, not just coding skills.

3. Why Me?

Not achievements.

Reasons.

Examples:

- Student perspective
 - Responsive-first
 - Smooth animations
 - Accessible design
 - Fast websites
-

4. Strong CTA

Right now:

Contact.

Instead:

Ready to modernize your department association's website?

Email me.

That's much stronger.

One page I'd remove

If I had to delete one page tomorrow:

Skills

Because projects already demonstrate your skills.

A visitor thinks:

"Cool, they know React."

Five seconds later:

"Can they redesign our website?"

The first answer doesn't help with the second.

Overall verdict

If I score it **against your proof statement**, not against other student portfolios:

Page	Verdict	Why
Home	●	Talks about you instead of the client's problem.
Skills	✗	Lists technologies instead of proving capability.
Projects	●	Shows coding ability, not evidence for your niche.
About	●	Needs to explain why you're suited to student communities.
Contact	●	Necessary, but email should be the clear primary action.

The biggest strategic issue

Right now, your portfolio says:

"I'm learning web development."

But your proof statement says:

"I redesign department association websites."

Those are two very different messages.

Everything on the site—from the hero text to the projects—needs to support the second message. When someone responsible for a department association visits, they should leave thinking:

"This person understands our kind of website and has the design skills to make it feel modern, active, and representative of our community."

That's the standard your portfolio should be aiming for.